

has a lower proportion of foreign skilled workers than London, New York and Los Angeles, but it wants to be seen as internationally competitive (Xie and Zhang, 2020).

Activities

- 1 Compare the challenges and opportunities brought about by urban growth in Shanghai.
 - 2 Assess the strengths and weaknesses of strategies to manage urban growth.
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Fieldwork

Urban fieldwork

The central business district (CBD) is the commercial and economic core of a city. It is the heart of the city and is the area that is most accessible by public transport. It has a number of characteristics:

- Multi-storey development: High land values force buildings to grow upwards, so the floor space of the CBD is much greater than the ground space.
- Concentration of retailing: Accessibility attracts shops with a high **range** and **threshold characteristics**. Department stores are located in CBDs; specialist shops occupy less accessible areas.
- Offices are concentrated in the CBD: Centrality favours office development.
- Vertical zoning is apparent: Shops occupy ground floors while offices occupy upper floors.
- Few people live in the CBD: A few luxury flats exist and there may be some artisans or university accommodation.
- Pedestrian flows and traffic restrictions are greatest in the CBD: Pedestrianisation has reduced areas for cars since the 1960s.

Possible hypotheses to test

Possible hypotheses that could be tested in the fieldwork include:

- The CBD is the most accessible area of the city for public transport.
- Building heights are highest in the CBD.
- Land use is mainly commercial – little land is used for residential or manufacturing purposes in the CBD.
- Pedestrian flows are greatest in the CBD.
- There are more parking restrictions in the CBD than elsewhere in a city.
- Vertical zoning is apparent.

Data collection

You could:

- compare different parts of the CBD, for example the core and frame, or compare the CBD with a suburban area, or take a transect from the centre of the CBD towards the edge of a small town/city
- use a base map of the city centre to mark off land use – make sure that you have a key to include different categories, such as commercial (high order), commercial (low order), finance (for example banks), restaurants, etc.
- record pedestrian flows at selected locations, counting the number of pedestrians passing you at 2-minute intervals
- analyse bus timetables to show the number and frequency of buses over several hours
- compare ground floor usage with that of upper floors to show vertical zoning.

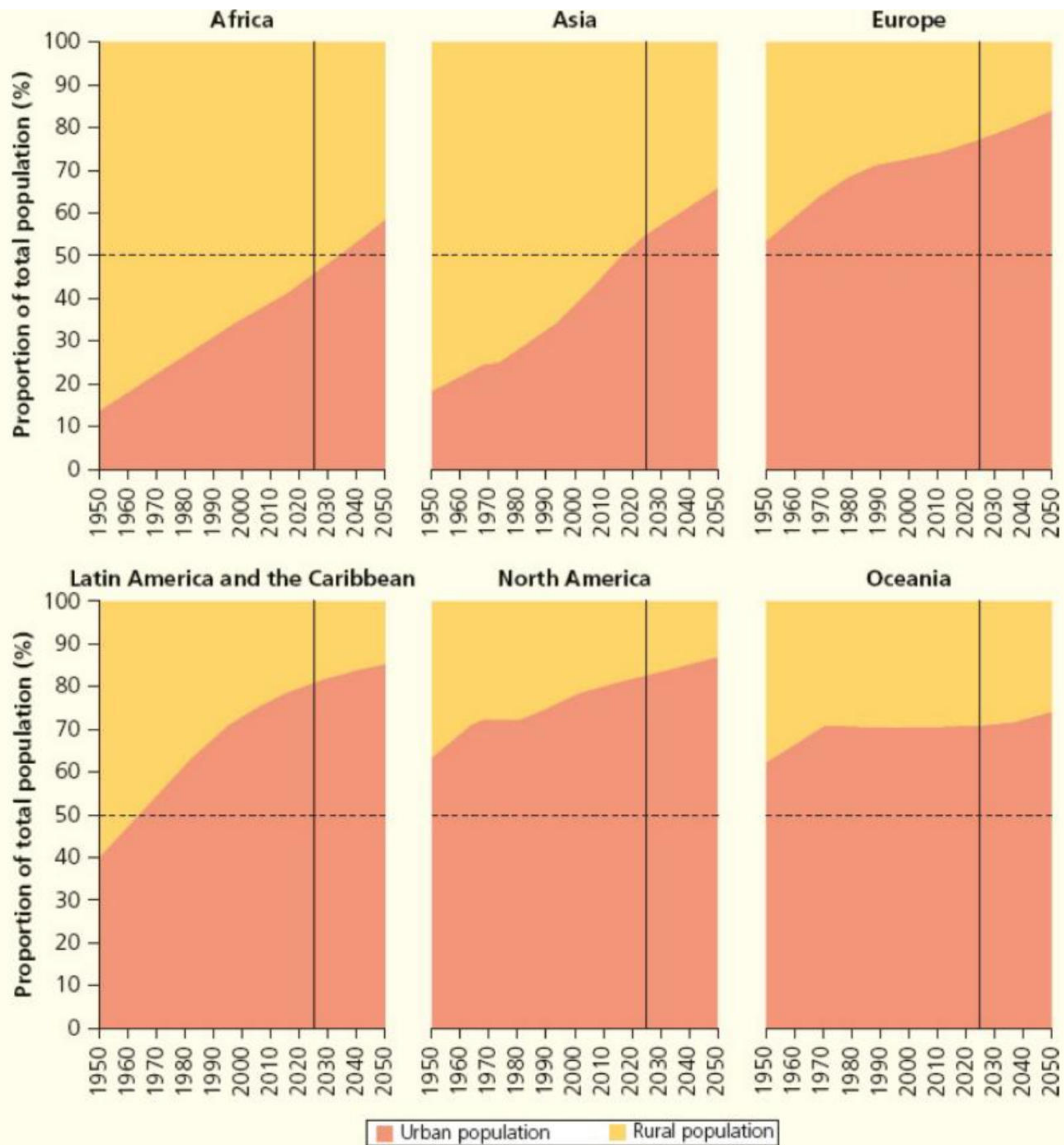
Along with these quantitative data forms you should take photographs on your phone to annotate later and provide qualitative data about the nature of the environment.

Presenting your findings

To present your findings you could use land-use maps, annotated photos, flowcharts of the number of buses, or located pie charts/bar charts to show pedestrian counts.

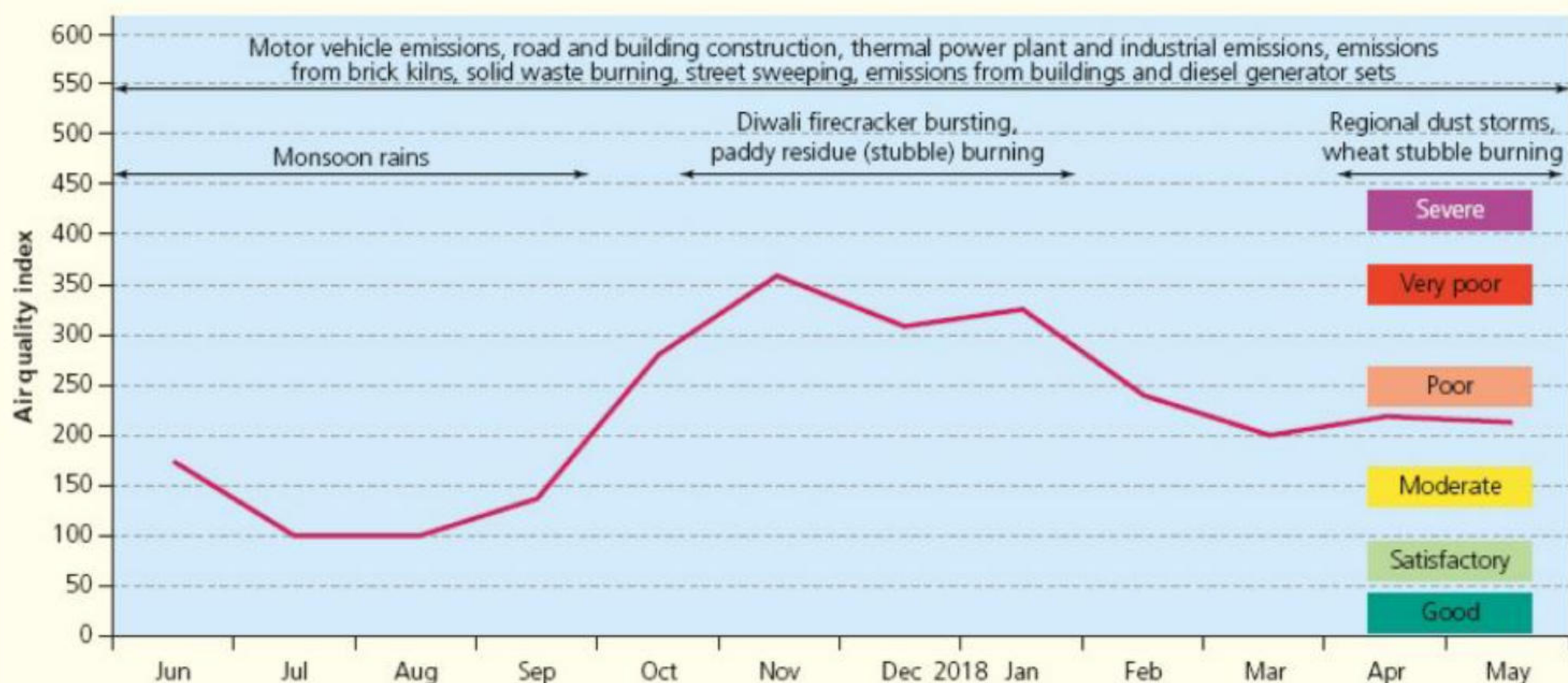
Practice questions

- 1 [Figure 7.23](#) shows changes in urban and rural populations by region between 1950 and 2050 (predicted from 2025).
 - a State the continent with the largest number of urban dwellers in 2025. [1]
 - b State the decade when 50 per cent of the population in Latin America and the Caribbean lived in urban areas. [1]
 - c Describe the trend in levels of urbanisation in Europe between 1950 and 2050 (predicted from 2025). [3]



▲ **Figure 7.23** Changes in urban and rural populations by region, 1950–2050 (projected)

2 [Figure 7.24](#) shows seasonal variations in air quality in Delhi. Explain the seasonal variations in air quality in Delhi. [5]



▲ **Figure 7.24** Seasonal variations in air quality in Delhi

3 [Figure 7.25](#) shows a development on the rural-to-urban fringe.

- Define the term 'rural-to-urban fringe'. [1]
- Suggest the advantages of the rural-to-urban fringe for new developments. [3]
- Assess the likely impacts of new developments in the rural-to-urban fringe on the environment. [4]

4 For a named example, assess the challenges and opportunities of urban living. [7]



▲ **Figure 7.25** A development on the rural-to-urban fringe